

Summer Cai

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EDUCATION

California Polytechnic State University, San Luis Obispo

Jun. 2025

Bachelor of Science in Computer Engineering, Cum Laude

SKILLS

Languages: Java, Python, TypeScript, JavaScript, SQL, C++, C

Technologies: Spring Boot, React, PostgreSQL, MySQL, Kafka, Kubernetes, Datadog, Git, Maven, Jenkins, Postman, JIRA

Concepts: Microservices, REST APIs, GraphQL, Distributed Systems, Event-Driven Architecture, CI/CD

EXPERIENCE

PayPal

Aug. 2025 - Present

Software Engineer

Austin, TX

- Developed Java/Spring Boot microservices and React/TypeScript applications supporting Braintree's global post-processing platform for merchant funding, settlement, disputes, and payment operations.
- Designed and built an AI-powered incident triage platform processing 400+ alerts per month across multiple observability systems, reducing triage time by 90% (from ~20 min to ~2 min) through automated diagnostics and root-cause insights delivered via Slack.
- Improved production observability by building a Datadog monitoring dashboard and alerting suite for a merchant processing 35M+ transactions and \$8.5B in quarterly TPV, enabling faster detection and investigation of payment-processing incidents.
- Investigated and resolved production issues involving batch processing, authorization declines, transaction failures, and merchant payment escalations across high-volume payment systems.

Western Digital

Jun. 2024 – Sept. 2024

Embedded Software Development Engineering Intern

Irvine, CA

- Developed and optimized firmware for enterprise hard disk drives using C++ and Python, incorporating Continuous Integration/Continuous Deployment (CI/CD) practices to ensure scalable, reliable code aligned with industry standards.
- Designed and implemented software algorithms and data paths, contributing to the efficient operation of hardware cores and systems, ensuring firmware functionality met performance expectations.
- Contributed to the restructuring of command handlers by designing standardized command execution files and objects, following the ACS6 standard to ensure consistency and accuracy in handling hardware commands.

PROJECTS

WeFit

Jan. 2025 - Jun. 2025

- Built WeFit, a social fitness iOS application in Swift/SwiftUI backed by Supabase (Postgres, Auth, Storage) for real-time data sync across 10+ active users.
- Implemented workout logging across 3 activity types (running, weightlifting, and basketball), a points-and-streaks gamification engine, and group challenges with goal tracking.
- Built a social feed with likes and comments backed by Supabase Storage for media uploads, enabling users to share workout photos/videos and engage with each other's progress.

Caltrans Traffic Detection System

Sept. 2024 - Mar. 2025

- Worked with Caltrans team and built a real-time traffic monitoring system using YOLOv8, ReactJS, ExpressJS, and PostgreSQL, automating vehicle detection, classification, and tracking from live Caltrans camera feeds.
- Optimized model accuracy (98%) and system performance, implementing multi-threaded buffering and cloud GPU acceleration for real-time processing and scalability.
- Developed an interactive dashboard for visualizing annotated traffic data, vehicle counts, and movement metrics, improving accessibility for transportation analysis.